

Chapter 32 — Qal–Piel–Pual Contrast Drill (Strong Roots)

BBH Chapter 32 · Pual Strong Verbs

Each triplet shows the same root in Qal, Piel, and Pual (Perfect 3ms). For each form: (1) identify the stem, (2) parse fully, (3) translate. Focus on the R1 vowel: variable (Qal), hiriq/tsere (Piel), qibbuts/holes (Pual). Answer key is on the last page.

Stem contrast (Perfect 3ms): Qal = qamets or tsere under R1, no dagesh in R2. Piel = hiriq or tsere under R1 + dagesh forte in R2. Pual = qibbuts under R1 + dagesh forte in R2 (holes when R2 is guttural and rejects dagesh).

Triplet 1 — Root: brk (bless)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
1	בָּרַךְ				
2	בִּרְךָ				
3	בִּרְכָּה				

Triplet 2 — Root: shlkh (send)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
4	שָׁלַח				
5	שִׁלַּחְךָ				
6	שִׁלְחָה				

Triplet 3 — Root: dbr (speak)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
7	דָּבַר				
8	דִּבַּרְךָ				
9	דִּבְרָה				

Triplet 4 — Root: kbd (honor)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
10	כָּבַד				
11	כִּבְדְּךָ				
12	כִּבְדָּה				

Triplet 5 — Root: spr (count / tell)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
13	סָפַר				
14	סָפַר				
15	סָפַר				

Reflection Questions

- Across all five triplets, the R1 vowel follows a pattern: gamets or tsere (Qal), hiriq or tsere (Piel), qibbutz (Pual). Write this as a three-step diagnostic rule.
- Root brk (triplets 1, 3): the resh (r) rejects dagesh forte in R2. How does this affect the Piel vowel (tsere under b instead of hiriq)? And the Pual vowel (holem instead of qibbutz)?
- Root kbd (triplet 4): the Qal is stative (he was heavy). What does the Piel add to make it factitive? What grammatical role does the human recipient play in Piel vs. Pual?

Answer Key

Triplet 1 — Root: brk (bless)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
1	בָּרַךְ				
✓	בָּרַךְ	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he knelt
2	בָּרַךְ				
✓	בָּרַךְ	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he blessed
3	בִּרְךָ				
✓	בִּרְךָ	Pual	Perfect	3ms	he was blessed

Triplet 2 — Root: shlkh (send)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
4	שָׁלַח				
✓	שָׁלַח	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he sent
5	שָׁלַח				
✓	שָׁלַח	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he sent away / released
6	שָׁלַח				
✓	שָׁלַח	Pual	Perfect	3ms	he was sent away

Triplet 3 — Root: dbr (speak)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
7	דָּבַר				
✓	דָּבַר	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he spoke (rare)
8	דָּבַר				
✓	דָּבַר	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he spoke
9	דָּבַר				
✓	דָּבַר	Pual	Perfect	3ms	it was spoken

Triplet 4 — Root: kbd (honor)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
10	קָבַד				
✓	קָבַד	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he was heavy / honored (stative)
11	קָבַד				
✓	קָבַד	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he honored
12	קָבַד				
✓	קָבַד	Pual	Perfect	3ms	he was honored

Triplet 5 — Root: spr (count / tell)

#	Form	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Translation
13	סָפַר				
✓	סָפַר	Qal	Perfect	3ms	he counted
14	סָפַר				
✓	סָפַר	Piel	Perfect	3ms	he recounted / told
15	סָפַר				
✓	סָפַר	Pual	Perfect	3ms	it was told / recounted